

# The CaseCash Shop — design sketch v1 (2026-08-07, for Stephen's markup)

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Goal: a second CaseCash sink with player agency ("buy items and generators with earned cash" — Stephen, 2026-08-06). Everything below prices against the shipped Schedule B economy; nothing here touches ingots, energy, or IAP.

## The economic frame (why this is safe to build)

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- CC income: **1,410/episode** + 500 FTUE. Existing sink: locker slots (200/400/800/1600 = 3,000 for all four). A typical player buys 1–2 slots and finishes Ep1 with **~700–1,100 CC idle**. That surplus is the shop's budget.
- Canon guardrail: **no CC→energy path, ever**. A bought ITEM is frozen energy (1 T1eq  $\approx$  0.6–0.7 energy at tuned drop rates), so item pricing must sit far above the earn yardstick. A bought GENERATOR is NOT — taps still cost energy — so generators are the safe headline product.
- Earn yardstick: 1,410 CC / 330 required T1eq  $\approx$  **4.3 CC per T1eq earned**.

## What's for sale

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| Slot              | Contents                                                                           | Price               | Limit                   |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------------------|
| 3 item offers     | Random DISCOVERED tiers (T2–T4 band) from families whose generator the player owns | Tier-priced (below) | Each offer buyable once |
| 1 generator offer | Duplicate T1 of an owned generator type                                            | Flat 400 CC         | 1/day                   |

- Stock refreshes at **local midnight** (same reset infra as the energy ladder; same backwards-clock clamp).
- **Discovered tiers only** — the shop reads ItemDiscoveryService, so it can never spoil a silhouette in the family view. The shop sells convenience, not discovery.

- T1 excluded (trivial, 1 tap); T5+ excluded (aspirational tiers stay earned).
- Delivery: purchases go to **the Stash** with the generator-arc flight — the

systems shipped this week do all the work.

## Pricing rule (items)

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**T1eq price = 12 CC** (~2.8× the earn yardstick — a visible convenience tax, steep enough that grinding energy is always the rational bulk path):

| Tier | T1eq | Price |
|------|------|-------|
| T2   | 2    | 25 CC |
| T3   | 4    | 50 CC |
| T4   | 8    | 95 CC |

Sanity check vs the wall leads: L8 needs 56 T1eq; buying it outright at shop prices  $\approx 670$  CC  $\approx$  half an episode's total CC on one lead — possible once as a splurge, never sustainable. The energy loop keeps primacy. Generator at 400 CC competes directly with locker slot 10 (400) — a real decision, which is the point of a sink.

## Where it lives

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- **Entry point: the cash pill's "+" button** — currently dead/greyed. It sits on the CC counter, it's already styled, and it gives the shop a home without a fourth corner button. (Energy "+" keeps opening the energy store.)

- **Fiction (needs Stephen's ruling):**

- (a) **Mo's Back Room** — the Rusty Anchor's neutral-ground trading post. Zero new canon (Mo exists, speaks, the bar is "cops and crooks coexist"), maximum charm. Recommended.

- (b) **Harbour Market** — new minor location, generic-safe but invents canon.
- (c) Fiction-light "MARKET" label, name it later.

## Gating and telemetry

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- Unlocked at **L5 (e1\_pod1 resolved)** — post-FTUE, first wall approaching, the moment surplus CC starts existing. Story flag gate, same idiom as family drops. Hidden entirely before then (dead + stays dead).
- Feature flag (FeatureFlagsRuntime) so it can ship dark if tuning slips.
- Analytics: offer impressions, purchases (slot, itemId/tier, price), balance at purchase — enough to see whether it cannibalizes locker slots.

## **v1 scope cuts**

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No ingot pricing, no energy, no cosmetics, no restock-early-for-ingots (classic monetization lever — defer, it complicates the no-CC→energy story), no bundle offers, no shopkeeper dialogue (a Mo line on first open would be lovely — one line, banked for the script pass).

## **Open rulings for Stephen**

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- Venue/name: Mo's Back Room / Harbour Market / plain MARKET?
- Items at all in v1, or generators-only MVP (the economically bulletproof version — items can follow after live data)?
- Price constants: 12 CC per T1eq and 400 CC generators feel right?
- Unlock at L5 confirmed?
- Generator offer: any type owned, or exclude the Field Kit (starting gen duplicates are the strongest board-acceleration item)?